

Why AI on Edge and What's the Tech Powering It

AI on Edge is not just a buzzword anymore. It holds value for the creators, enablers as well as the end-users. But what are some of the top use-cases, and what tech is available to empower creators for carving out AI on edge? This was discussed by the panel of experts on this subject in October 2020 during India Electronics Week. Their thoughts and key points have been compiled and presented below.



There has been a lot of hype around AI on edge. IoT and AI are not just buzzwords anymore. Consumers, businesses, and enterprises are all looking to adopt digital transformation in their processes and lives. It is important to consider the kind of experiences or values that can be given to the end-user, whether it is B2B or B2C use cases.

At the same time, it is not just enough to know how to build, but also what to build. A lot of techies build things that do not sell. Since these are critical times, there are not enough resources to waste.

The journey till date

Traditionally, AI has been used to identify patterns out of the collected data, saving the data, and making inferences with respect to a business case. It used to demand large computing resources and large datasets, which typically were housed in centralised data centres.

AI did not happen in last ten to fifteen years; it has been happening since the 1950s. But the sheer computing power required to run heavy compute loads became cost-effective about fifteen to twenty years back. It was then that cloud brought inexpensive computing and started giving way to AI

and machine learning (ML) workloads to be run on the cloud.

As we all know, IoT technology refers to devices having the ability to talk to the Internet, push data to the cloud, and also have the ability to control or get controlled remotely. AI is a set of frameworks that makes these devices capable of taking their own decisions. Edge computing refers to when the devices can take self-decisions or have local servers through which data can be processed.

“As computing became cheaper, particularly with supercomputers in the form of smartphones and various IoT devices at our expense, the need